Year-End Relationship Review Journal

Prompts, reflections and a plan to close the year with clarity and start the next one steadier.

How to use this journal

Set aside 20–30 minutes per section. Write alone first; if you share it with a partner, swap only the pages you choose. There are no right answers, only honest ones.

Two ideas worth keeping in mind

• Relationship researchers at The Gottman Institute report that stable couples have about five positive interactions for every negative one during conflict.[1]

• In a six-year follow-up of newlyweds, couples who stayed married "turned toward" each other's bids for connection 86% of the time; couples who divorced did so 33% of the time.[2]

This journal applies to any close relationship: a partner, a parent, a friend. Pick one per copy.

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1. The year at a glance

Three words for this year in this relationship:

Our best day this year, and what made it good:

The hardest stretch, and what got us through:

What surprised me about us:

2. Moments of connection

Times I felt seen or cared for:

Small, everyday things that mattered more than I expected:

Bids for attention I noticed, and how I responded (turned toward, away, or against):

A ritual we kept (or want to start):

3. Conflict and repair

The argument we kept having, in one sentence:

What I was really asking for underneath it:

A repair attempt that worked (theirs or mine):

Where I got defensive, and what I would say instead now:

4. Boundaries

A boundary I set and held this year:

A boundary I needed but didn't say:

Where I said yes but meant no:

One sentence I'll practice next year:

5. Growth

How I've grown in this relationship:

How they've grown:

Something I'm still learning:

A pattern from my family I noticed in myself:

6. Gratitude

Ten things I appreciate about them:

Something I never said thank you for:

A quality of theirs I'd like more of in me:

7. Letting go

What I'm ready to forgive or release:

An expectation that no longer fits:

What I'd tell myself from January:

8. Looking ahead

How I want this relationship to feel next December:

Three intentions for next year:

One conversation we need to have, and when:

What support I'll ask for:

9. Monthly highlights

Month	A good moment	A hard moment
January		
February		
March		
April		
May		
June		
July		
August		
September		
October		
November		
December		

10. Talk it through together (optional)

Pick 3–5 questions for a calm, unhurried conversation. Agree on a 20-minute break if it heats up.

☐ What was your favorite moment with me this year?

☐ When did you feel most supported by me?

☐ What's one thing I could do more of next year?

☐ What's one thing you'd like us to stop doing?

☐ What's a dream you want my help with?

☐ How do you most like to be shown love right now?

☐ What's something you've been afraid to bring up?

☐ What tradition do you want to keep?

My commitment

Signed: _____ Date: _____

Sources

1. The Gottman Institute, "The Magic Relationship Ratio, According to Science." https://www.gottman.com/blog/the-magic-relationship-ratio-according-science/ (accessed Nov 4, 2026)

2. The Gottman Institute, "Turn Toward Instead of Away." https://www.gottman.com/blog/turn-toward-instead-of-away/ (accessed Nov 4, 2026)

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